

How is Ahithophel related to Bath-sheba?

Acts 17:11, 1Th 5:21

2 Samuel 11:3

And David sent and enquired after the woman. And one said, Is not this Bath-sheba, the daughter of Eliam, the wife of Uriah the Hittite?

2 Samuel 12:24

And David comforted Bath-sheba his wife, and went in unto her, and lay with her: and she bare a son, and he called his name Solomon: and the LORD loved him.

1 Chronicles 3:5

And these were born unto him in Jerusalem; Shimea, and Shobab, and Nathan, and Solomon, four, of Bath-shua the daughter of Ammiel:

2 Samuel 23:34

Eliphelet the son of Ahasbai, the son of the Maachathite, Eliam the son of Ahithophel the Gilonite,

- From the scripture above the following conditions are set forth for their kinship:
 - Bathsheba is the daughter of Eliam
 - Bathsheba is the daughter of Ammiel
 - Eliam is the son of Ahithophel
- So, in order to figure out more precisely how Bathsheba and Ahithophel are related it is crucial that we first learn how they are both related to both Eliam and Ammiel.
- It is plainly evident from all of scripture that when it reads “the son of” or “the daughter of” it does not necessitate that one is the direct descendant of another.
 - For example:
 - 1Ki 15:11-13 / 2Ch 15:16
 - Asa and “Maachah his mother” / “Maachah the mother of Asa”
 - Proof that she is his grandmother: 1Ki 15:1,2,8, 2Ch 11:18-22, 12:16
 - Luk 13:16
 - “...daughter of Abraham...”
 - There’s roughly 1,855 years between Abraham and this woman.
 - 1Sa 1:16 / 1Sa 25:17
 - Hannah, daughter of Belial / Nabal, son of Belial
 - “Belial” (17x) is always used figuratively and it’s definition taken from the Bible itself is “evil, naughty, ungodly men, wicked”.
 - Mat 9:27, 15:22, 20:30,31, 21:9,15,42, Mar 10:47,48, 12:35, Luk 18:38,39
 - Jesus, Son of David (Mat 1:17)
 - Many Bible notes and commentaries assert that Ahithophel is Bathsheba’s grandfather and if any proof is offered at all they generally assert that it is because Eliam and Ammiel are the same man. But, can we prove that with scripture? Let’s look at the evidence and draw our own conclusion purely from scripture (1Th 5:21).
- 2Sa 11:3, 23:34 are the only mentions of any “Eliam” (H463) and there are no parallel passages or other verses that are clearly about the same man and also prove unequivocally that he is called by any other name.
- If you haven’t already, review every mention of Ahithophel^{H302} (20x), Bath-sheba^{H1339} (11x) /Bath-shua^{H1340} (2x) to find any more supporting evidence.
- The only person left to review is Ammiel.

Every mention of “Ammiel” (H5988)
(6 times in 6 verses in 5 chapters in 3 books)

Book	Verse	Context	Same Ammiel as 1Ch 3:5?
Num 13:12	Of the tribe of Dan, Ammiel ^{H5988} the son of Gemalli.	Spies sent to search the land of Canaan just before the end of the exodus.	If all parties involved obeyed God's law, definitely not. Ahithophel was from Giloh so he is either of the tribe of Judah or Levi (Jos 15:20-51, 2Sa 15:12, Num 36:9).
2Sa 9:4	And the king said unto him, Where is he? And Ziba said unto the king, Behold, he [Mephibosheth] is in the house of Machir, the son of Ammiel ^{H5988} , in Lodebar.	Mephibosheth son of Jonathan son of Saul is sought for by David to show him the kindness of God.	Probably not. Every mention of Machir up until this point is referring to Machir the son of Mannaseh the son of Joseph the son of Jacob the son of Isaac the son of Abraham. There is no Ammiel listed in the genealogies where Mannaseh or Machir appear. The oldest chronological mention of an Ammiel is of the tribe of Dan (above) which is not an option.
2Sa 9:5	Then king David sent, and fetched him [Mephibosheth] out of the house of Machir, the son of Ammiel ^{H5988} , from Lodebar.		
2Sa 17:27	And it came to pass, when David was come to Mahanaim, that Shobi the son of Nahash of Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and Machir the son of Ammiel ^{H5988} of Lodebar, and Barzillai the Gileadite of Rogelim,	After David left Jerusalem during Absalom's rebellion supplies are brought to him in Mahanaim.	
1Ch 26:5	Ammiel ^{H5988} the sixth, Issachar the seventh, Peulthai the eighth: for God blessed him.	David distributes the Levites for their specific services. cf. 1Ch 15:18	Probably not. This Ammiel is listed as a son of Obed-edom the Gittite (the porter; of Gath or of Gittaim). Even though he's the closest match to the Ammiel of 1Ch 3:5 he is most likely too young to be the father of Ahithophel and probably too young to be both the son of Ahithophel and the father of Bathsheba. Regardless, these verses don't add any new evidence to what we already know.

And so, from scripture only, we are left with the following criterion for their genealogy:

- 28a 23:34
 - Eliam is a descendant of Ahithophel.
 - Eliam lived between Ahithophel and Bathsheba.
 - Eliam is not necessarily the direct descendant of Ahithophel.
- 28a 11:3, 1Ch 3:5
 - Bathsheba is a descendant of both Eliam and Ammiel.
 - Eliam and Ammiel came before Bathsheba but are not necessarily her direct ancestors.
- 28a 15,16,17
 - Ahithophel is alive at the same time as both David and Bathsheba.
 - Life expectancy of this time period was very roughly around 70 (David) to a little over 80 (Barzillai) which means Ahithophel likely did not live to see his great-grandchildren (but he could have if he lived longer than that).
- We do not know what time period Ammiel lived in aside from that he came before Bathsheba.
 - He is not necessarily the direct ancestor of any other person.

Because we have no other conditions, multiple possibilities arise (none of which can be proven with scripture):

Ahithophel → Eliam → Ammiel → Bathsheba	Ahithophel → Ammiel → Eliam → Bathsheba
Ammiel → Ahithophel → Eliam → Bathsheba	Ahithophel → Ammiel/Eliam → Bathsheba

No matter which possibility we subscribe to we cannot prove any one of them using *only scripture*.

Interesting side notes:

- Before David, Bathsheba was married to Uriah the *Hittite*
 - [Gen 10:15](#), [23:10](#), [49:32](#) together teach us that the Hittites were descendants of Heth the son of Canaan. (Noah → Ham → Canaan → Heth → Hittites [Gen 10:1-15](#))
- Eliam is Ammiel reversed and vice-versa (El-i-am ↔ Amm-i-el).

El	Am(m)
God	(noun) people or kinsman
God of (the) people, God is kinsman	

Am(m)	El
(noun) people or kinsman	God
My kinsman is God; One of the people of God; people of God	